



Historic shipwrecks

One of the most exciting forms of exploration at sea is finding, excavating, and even raising historic shipwrecks. Many of these wrecks lie in shallow coastal waters, which are accessible to scuba divers. But others have plunged into the deep ocean, and have only recently been rediscovered using deep-sea submersibles.



Kyrenia ship
Ancient timber

Date of sinking about 300 BCE
Depth of water 108 ft (33 m)
Rediscovery date 1965

Discovered by a scuba diver near Kyrenia on the Mediterranean island of Cyprus, these timbers are the remains of a Greek merchant ship that sank more than 2,300 years ago. Salvaged along with its cargo of wine jars and many other objects, it gives us a glimpse into the ancient world.

Mary Rose
Tudor warship



Date of sinking 1545
Depth of water 36 ft (11 m)
Rediscovery date 1971

One of the biggest ships in the navy of King Henry VIII of England, the *Mary Rose* sank just off the English coast during a sea battle. It settled on its side, half-buried in the mud. The exposed timber was soon eaten away, but the buried side was preserved with all its contents, and was raised in 1982.



Vasa
Amazing survival

Date of sinking 1628
Depth of water 105 ft (32 m)
Rediscovery date 1956

The Swedish warship *Vasa* sank on her very first voyage after sailing just 0.80 miles (1.3 km) from the dockside in Stockholm harbor. It was a national disaster. The wooden ship lay on the seabed for 333 years, but thanks to the cold, airless water of the Baltic Sea, the exposed timber was not destroyed by marine life. This allowed the ship to be raised almost intact in 1961, along with most of its equipment and the ornate carvings that had adorned it.

◀ SHIP MUSEUM

The restored Vasa is now housed in a special museum in Stockholm, Sweden. Most of the timber is original, but has been treated with chemicals designed to stop it from decaying.